

trendyol

TRANSPARENCY REPORT

31 December 2024

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1. General

Average Monthly Active Recipients: Refers to the average number of unique users who actively engaged with the platform each month during the reporting period. This includes activities such as browsing, purchasing, posting comments, or other meaningful interactions.

Content moderators: Individuals or teams responsible for reviewing and taking action on reported content based on platform policies.

DSA: Regulation (EU) 2022/2065 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 19 October 2022 on a Single Market For Digital Services and amending Directive 2000/31/EC Regulation (EU) 2022/2065 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 19 October 2022 on a Single Market For Digital Services and amending Directive 2000/31/EC (Digital Services Act).

Illegal content: Any content that violates applicable laws and/or Trendyol's terms of use. Illegal content is a broad term that can take many different forms. It may, among other things, refer to content that in itself violates the law, such as the sale of counterfeit products, fraud, hate speech, or discrimination.

Internal Complaints Handling: Our internal complaints handling process allows Users to challenge our decisions made in response to Notices. This section provides insights into the frequency of challenges and the outcomes, whether decisions were upheld or reversed.

Notices: Notices are reports submitted by customers, Trusted Flaggers, or other stakeholders alerting us to potentially illegal content on our platform. We provide an overview of the number of Notices received and our response.

Out-of-Court Settlement: Users also have the option of seeking an independent review and settling disputes through out-of-court settlement bodies. We facilitate this process to ensure fair resolution outside of legal proceedings.

Orders: Orders are requests from authorities of EU Member States to take action against illegal content. We provide information on the number of orders received and how we've addressed them.

Online Platform: It refers to both the mobile application and the Trendyol website.

Reporter: A User or Seller who flags a concern about a product, comment, or other violation of our platform policies. Reporters can be anyone who encounters potentially inappropriate content, regardless of whether they are directly affected by it. This can include individuals as well as businesses and other organizations. They help us maintain a safe and responsible online environment by bringing potential violations to our attention.

Suspensions: Temporary restrictions placed on User accounts, Seller accounts, or product listings due to policy violations.

Seller: A third party that sells products on our online platform.

Trusted Flaggers: Trusted Flaggers are individuals or organizations recognized by the Digital Service Coordinator for their expertise in detecting illegal content. The Digital Services Coordinator has not been appointed as of this report's publication.

User: Refers to any natural or legal person or entity that uses our Online Platform and is not a Seller. This also includes members and guests, unless the respective regulations explicitly differentiate between Users, guests, and members.

Very Large Online Platforms (VLOPs): Platforms designated under the Digital Services Act (DSA) based on their size and reach, exceed 45 million monthly active Users in the European Union. Due to their potential impact on society, VLOPs face stricter obligations under the DSA regarding Content Moderation, transparency, and risk management.

2. About

We were founded in 2010 with a dynamic and agile start-up spirit to make a positive impact on customers and sellers by creating a flawless e-commerce experience.

At Trendyol, we believe that technology is the driver; e-commerce is the outcome. Thanks to our dedicated team, we are one of the top five e-commerce companies in EMEA and one of the fastest-growing e-commerce companies in the world. Our commitment revolves around fostering a secure environment for all our users. This includes fostering a trustworthy environment where the Users can seamlessly purchase products and Sellers can operate with integrity.

As part of this commitment, we prioritize to be transparent about our Content Moderation practices, in accordance with the Digital Services Act (DSA). This transparency report aims to shed light on our efforts to ensure a safe online shopping experience for everyone.

3. Information on Average Monthly Active Recipients in the European Union

Average Monthly Active Recipients

In accordance with the DSA, we publish the number of Average Monthly Active Recipients on our platforms in the EU to ensure transparency and regulatory compliance.

For the period of August 2023 to February 2024:

We reported that the Average Monthly Number of Active Recipients within the EU was approximately 27 million. This calculation included all individuals who interacted with our platform at least once during the specified period. However, the calculation method at that time included potential double-counting, as recipients accessing the platforms via multiple devices (e.g., phone and laptop) could be counted more than once.

For the period of February 2024 to August 2024:

To enhance accuracy, we revised our calculation method to ensure that each recipient who interacted with our platform at least once during the specified period is counted only once, regardless of access via multiple devices or sessions. Under this method, we include both authenticated (registered) and non-authenticated (guest) users in the EU, as well as sellers, who are classified as active recipients under the DSA. Where applicable, we counted each active recipient as one.

In alignment with Recital 77 of the DSA, we excluded incidental users who interacted with our platform indirectly, such as through linking or indexing by a search engine provider, as they do not meet the engagement criteria for active recipients.

As of our latest assessment during the specified period, the Average Monthly Number of Active Users totals **23.607 millions**, remaining below the threshold for classification as a VLOP under the DSA. This approach reflects our commitment to transparency and compliance with the DSA's regulatory requirements.

4. Content Moderation in the context of the DSA

The DSA defines Content Moderation as the **"measures taken by intermediary service providers to prevent, detect, and remove illegal content and address other risks of harm arising from the use of their services."** These measures include a wide range of activities, from proactively identifying and removing illegal content to responding to Notices and addressing emerging risks.

In alignment with our commitment to fostering a safe and user-friendly online shopping experience, we have adopted a dual approach, combining **proactive** and **reactive** measures to address potentially harmful or illegal content.

4.1. Proactive Content Moderation

Proactive Content Moderation involves measures taken before content is published on our platform to prevent potential violations. We utilize a combination of **policies, Seller rules, algorithms**, and **human moderation** to prevent illegal content on our platform.

- **Seller obligations:** We establish clear and comprehensive obligations for Sellers, including product safety standards, intellectual property rights, and adherence to other legal regulations.
- **Policies:** We establish a clear and comprehensive 'Product Commenting Guideline' outlining acceptable and unacceptable behaviors on our platform. This guideline is readily accessible to all Users and informs them how to engage in respectful and constructive commentary. For more information, please refer to the 'Product Commenting Guideline' available in the Help & FAQ section.
- **Commenting section algorithm:** We employ advanced algorithms as part of our dual approach to post-publication Content Moderation. These automated systems are designed to detect and remove illegal or policy-violating content, such as harassment, discriminatory language, hate speech, or other inappropriate material. The algorithms use predefined parameters, including keyword detection and image analysis, to identify potentially harmful content.
 - When the algorithm detects prohibited content with a high level of confidence, it automatically takes appropriate action, such as rejecting or removing the comment.
 - If the algorithm is unsure about the nature of the content, it flags it for review by human moderators. This team carefully evaluates flagged content against a comprehensive set of rules to ensure compliance with **Trendyol's Terms of Use**, policies, and applicable laws.

This proactive approach is further supported by **reactive moderation**, where inappropriate content is identified through quality controls, user feedback, or reports and manually reviewed.

- **Human Moderation:** A dedicated team of experienced human moderators actively reviews products listed on our platform and User comments to ensure compliance with Trendyol's terms of use, other policies, and applicable laws. This proactive review process helps prevent the publication of products that might be harmful, illegal, or violate our community standards.

4.2. Reactive Content Moderation

Reactive Content Moderation refers to measures taken after content is published on our platform, in response to User reports or identified issues. We use advanced algorithms, tools, and human monitoring to detect illegal content related to products offered for sale on the online platform.

- **Platform review:** Dedicated content moderators regularly review our platform for content published by Sellers and User comments that violate Trendyol's terms and

conditions, Trendyol's terms of use, policies, and applicable laws. This involves identifying and removing illegal, harmful, or misleading content.

- **Automated tools for the products:** Trendyol employs advanced automated tools as part of its Content Moderation efforts to ensure compliance with applicable laws and platform policies. These tools leverage image-based similarity algorithms to identify products that closely resemble known branded items. This process helps protect intellectual property rights and maintain compliance with applicable law and Trendyol policies.

Image similarity detection: One of our core algorithms identifies products based on image-based similarity. It analyzes visual elements of listed products and compares them against a database of known branded items. Products that meet or exceed a high level of similarity threshold are flagged. These flagged items are then processed automatically by our system for removal.

Trademark and logo detection: Another algorithm is designed to detect distinctive brand elements, such as trademarks, logos or unique patterns associated with the specific trademarks. This tool helps identify products that may infringe on intellectual property rights. In high-confidence cases, the system flags items and automatically remove them from the platform.

If the algorithm does not achieve a high level of confidence or similarity, the content remains on the platform. To ensure fairness and minimize errors, Trendyol is actively exploring mechanisms for reviewing uncertain cases. Currently, manually reopened cases are reviewed as part of an ongoing effort to refine moderation workflows.

- **Training and Support for Human Moderators:** We provide trainings to ensure our human moderators can effectively and fairly manage content flagged by the Reporters. These trainings focus on understanding Trendyol's terms of use, platform policies, and applicable laws, including the principles of the DSA. Moderators are trained using practical examples and scenarios to address sensitive or complex cases that may arise during Content Moderation. Additionally, they receive regular updates to stay informed about new policies and changes to legal frameworks, ensuring consistent and fair decision-making in our Content Moderation processes.
- **Reporting Mechanisms:** While we have measures in place to ensure a secure online environment, we also provide Users and Sellers with reporting systems that provide them the option to report any content they believe may violate Trendyol's terms of use, other Trendyol policies, or applicable laws. The Reporter agrees to express their sincere belief in good faith that the information provided is accurate and complete by submitting the report.

- **Product Report:** If the User sees a product that violates our product policies, such as trademark infringement, misleading descriptions, safety, or other concerns, they can report it using the *"Report legal concerns"* button at the bottom of the 'Product Detail Page'.

This allows Users and Sellers to flag concerns they encounter regarding products on our platform, categorized into specific sections for efficient handling. These sections include but are not limited to:

- **Intellectual property concerns:** Reports can be submitted under this section if a product is suspected of violating trademark, copyright, or design rights, or if it is counterfeit.
 - **Inappropriate content concerns:** This section is for reporting products displaying illegal symbols, offensive material that discriminates against individuals or groups, nudity, or content inappropriate for minors.
 - **Product description concerns:** Missing, inaccurate, or misleading product information can be reported under this section.
 - **Product safety concerns:** Concerns about products posing potential allergic reactions, safety risks, or lacking mandatory safety information should be reported under this category.
 - **Other concerns:** For issues not covered by the above categories, the free-text field can be used to provide a detailed description of the concern.
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- **Comment Report:** Users who encounter inappropriate comments on product pages can report them using the *"Report"* button. Reports can be categorized into the following sections, but are not limited to:
 - **Spam:** Repetitive, irrelevant, unsolicited content, or information unrelated to the context.
 - **Fraud:** Deceptive practices, scams, or misleading statements intended to harm or mislead others.
 - **Hate Speech:** Content that promotes discrimination, hostility, or violence based on race, ethnicity, religion, gender, or other protected characteristics.
 - **Harassment or Bullying:** Persistent or offensive behavior causing discomfort, fear, or distress to individuals.
 - **Nudity or Sexual Content:** Explicit or adult material, including sexually suggestive language or images, unsuitable for all audiences.
 - **Child Abuse:** Content that exploits or endangers children in any form.
 - **Misinformation:** False or misleading information that could harm individuals, groups, or public safety.

- **Promotional Content:** Comments suspected of being financially influenced without proper disclosure or placed for personal gain.
- **Privacy Violations:** Sharing personal information, such as names, addresses, or images, without explicit consent.
- **Violence:** Content depicting, promoting, or glorifying physical or psychological harm.
- **Suicide or Self-Harm:** Comments encouraging or promoting self-destructive behaviors or actions.
- **Illegal Political Symbols or Organizations:** References to prohibited political symbols or organizations.
- **Unlawful Content:** Any content that violates national or international laws, such as copyright or trademark infringement, or promotes illegal activities.
- **Other:** For concerns not covered under the above categories, a free-text field is available for detailed descriptions.

How We Address Reports

When a report is submitted through the product or comment reporting mechanism, our content moderators review it to determine whether the reported content complies with Trendyol's terms of use, platform policies, and applicable laws, or is identified as illegal content. If the report is deemed valid—meaning the content violates our terms, policies, or legal requirements, or constitutes illegal content—immediate action is taken, such as removing the product or comment. The relevant parties are then informed of the outcome.

5. Measures and protection against misuse

Trendyol strives to offer a safe and compliant platform for all Users. To achieve this, if we determine the reported product or comment is illegal and/or violates Trendyol's terms of use, Trendyol policies, and applicable laws, we may impose restrictions on the comment or the product itself or even suspend or terminate accounts under certain circumstances.

Types of Restrictions:

- **Removal or limitation of content:** This includes removing, or limiting the visibility of certain information deemed illegal or violating Trendyol's terms of use or policies.
- **Account suspension or termination:** This may occur for frequent violations of our terms of use or policies, submission of unfounded complaints, or consistent sharing of illegal content.

Factors Considered in Restriction Decisions:

- **The absolute number of abuses:** We take into account the absolute number of obviously illegal content or unfounded reports or complaints submitted within a certain

time. This helps us to understand the extent of the problem and its impact on its platform.

- **Relative share in proportion:** We also analyze the relative share of these abuses in relation to the total number of information provided or reports submitted within the same period. This ratio provides information about the prevalence of the report on the platform.
- **Severity of abuse:** We also assess the severity of the abuse, taking into account the nature of the illegal content and its consequences. This assessment helps to evaluate the severity of the situation and the potential harm.
- **The intention of the parties involved:** Where possible, we take into account the intention of the User or Seller.

Incorporating these factors into the decision-making process allows us to make fair, proportionate, and informed decisions when imposing restrictions on content or accounts.

6. Legal options

We understand that the Reporter may not always agree with our Content Moderation decisions. If the Reporter believes a product or comment was removed incorrectly or their account was restricted unfairly, they have the following options:

6.1. Appeal the Decision

- Reporters can submit an appeal through our **Internal Complaint Handling System**.
- Details and a link to the appeal system are provided in the decision update email.
- Appeals are free of charge and must be submitted electronically within six months of the decision or action.
- This process allows Reporters to request a reconsideration of the decision or action taken by Trendyol.

6.2. Out-of-Court Dispute Resolution

- If a reporter disagrees with the outcome of an appeal, they may apply for dispute resolution through a certified out-of-court dispute settlement body under **Article 21 of the DSA**. These bodies provide independent reviews of disputes outside formal legal proceedings. Each certified body publishes detailed rules and procedures for filing a claim.
- The European Commission maintains and updates a list of certified out-of-court dispute settlement bodies. For more information about these certified bodies, Reporters may visit the [European Commission's website](#).

Important: Please note that decisions by out-of-court dispute resolution bodies are non-binding for all parties involved, including Trendyol.

6.3. Legal Proceedings

- Applying to an out-of-court dispute settlement body does not affect the reporter's right to initiate legal proceedings in accordance with applicable laws.
- If the reporter is not satisfied with the resolution provided through internal or out-of-court channels, they may initiate legal proceedings in accordance with applicable laws in the competent courts.

For more information about the DSA, how the reporting works, Internal complaints procedure, and other legal remedies, please visit our [Digital Services Act](#) page under the Help & FAQ section.

7. Notices

This transparency report is being published on 31.12.2024, covering the period from 16.02.2024 to 23.12.2024. Our commitment to transparency and accountability drives us to provide regular updates on our compliance efforts and ongoing enhancements to content moderation practices.

The next report will be published by the end of December, 2025. Through these periodic reports, we aim to offer insights into our dedication to upholding regulatory standards and fostering a secure and ethical digital ecosystem for our users.

7.1 Number of Authority Orders

Not Available*

**Please note that during the reporting period, Trendyol did not receive any "authority orders" from EU Member States. This data will be included in future reports as soon as it becomes available.*

7.2 Number of Product Report Notices

During the reporting period, Trendyol received a total of 3,161 Notices from Reporters. Of these, 1,451 notices **were not** related to content governed by the DSA. These notices primarily involved product, shipment, or account concerns, which did not involve illegal content or violations of our terms and conditions. As a result, these notices were categorized as "no action taken" by human moderators, and Reporters were directed to contact our Customer Support team for further assistance.

All Notices are reviewed exclusively by human moderators to ensure accuracy and fairness, rather than relying on automated systems. Each notice is carefully evaluated against Trendyol's terms of use, policies, and applicable laws to determine the appropriate action.

Number of Notices Submitted by Users or Sellers	Number of Notices Submitted by Trusted Flaggers
3161*	0

**Please see the above explanation.*

7.2.1 Breakdown of Product Notices by Reason

The Reason of the Notice	Number of Notices by Reason of the Notice
Intellectual Property Concerns	531
Inappropriate Content Concerns	216
Product Description Concerns	780
Product Safety Concerns	139
Other Concerns	1495

7.2.2 Decisions for the Product Reports

Action Taken	No Action Taken
305	2856*

**Please note that out of the 2,856 Notices, 1,451 were marked as "No action taken." This status was automatically assigned by human moderators to cases unrelated to the DSA. These Notices primarily involved customer-related issues, such as product, shipment, or account concerns.*

7.2.3. Action taken pursuant to the Notice

Type of Actions	Number of Actions
Remove content	61
Disable access to content	0
Suspend monetary payments	0
Partially suspend provision of the service	0
Totally suspend provision of the service	0
Suspend the account	0
Other*	244

**Please note that the "Other" category includes actions related to missing or incorrect product information that has been identified and corrected.*

7.2.4. Ground for Action Taken Decision

Action Taken	Number
Based on law	0
Based on Terms and Conditions	305
Notices processed by automated means	0

7.2.5. Time to process Notices and Median time needed for taking action

Time to process Notices	Median time needed for taking action
10 days*	30 days*

**Please note that these timeframes are estimates and may vary slightly depending on the complexity of the Notice and specific requirements.*

7.3. Breakdown of Comment Notices by Reason

Number of Notices Submitted by Users or Sellers	Number of Notices Submitted by Trusted Flaggers
114*	0

**Please note that these 114 Notices include categories such as Spam, Fraud, Hate Speech, Harassment or Bullying, Nudity or Sexual Content, Child Abuse, Misinformation, Promotional Content, Privacy Violations, Violence, Illegal Political Symbols or Organizations, Unlawful Content, and Other.*

7.3.1 Decisions for the Comment Notices

Action Taken	No Action Taken
24	90

7.3.2. Breakdown for the Comment Notice Action Taken reasons

The Reasons	Action taken
Spam	0
Fraud	4
Hate Speech	0
Harassment or Bullying	0
Nudity or Sexual Content	1
Child Abuse	0
Misinformation	18

Promotional Content	0
Privacy Violation	0
Violence	0
Suicide or Self-harm	0
Illegal Political Symbols or Illegal Organizations	0
Unlawful Content	1
Other	0

7.3.3. Ground for Action Taken decision

Action Taken	Number of Actions
Based on law	0
Based on Terms and Conditions	24
Notices processed by automated means	0

7.3.4. Time to process Notices and Median time needed for taking action

Time to process Notices	Median time needed for taking action
10 days*	30 days*

**Please note that these timeframes are estimates and may vary slightly depending on the complexity of the Notices and specific requirements.*

7.4. Information about Trendyol's Own Initiative Content Moderation

We understand that a safe and trustworthy online shopping experience is essential for both our Users and Sellers. In this regard, we've implemented a robust Content Moderation system that combines proactive and reactive measures. This dual approach ensures a positive and secure shopping environment for everyone. By combining technology and human expertise, we create a space where trust and a responsible online shopping experience.

For more information about our comprehensive Content Moderation practices, including proactive measures and User reporting channels, please see the section **"4. Content Moderation in the context of the DSA"**.

Action taken by Trendyol's own initiative	The number of actions taken by Trendyol's own initiative
Product Removal	24054*
Comment Removal	30983*
Partially suspend provision of the service	0
Totally suspend provision of the service	0
Suspend the account	0
Suspend monetary payments	0

**Trendyol uses advanced algorithms to detect and remove products and comments. These numbers reflect the content removed by the algorithm throughout 2024. However, in some cases, both products and comments may have been reviewed and reactivated manually by human moderators after further assessment. As a result, these numbers may include products or comments that were temporarily removed and later reactivated.*

7.5. Internal Complaint Handling System / Out-of-Court Dispute Settlement

The Number of Appeals Received by the Internal Complaint Handling System	The Number of Appeals Submitted to out-of-court Dispute Settlement Bodies
0	0

7.5.1 The Number of Decisions Upheld or Reversed for the Appeals

Decision being Upheld	Decision being Reversed
0	0

7.5.2 Time to process Appeals and Median time needed for taking action

Time to process Notices	Median time needed for taking action
n/a*	n/a*

**Please note that during the reporting period, Trendyol did not receive any Appeals from the Reporters. This data will be included in future reports as soon as it becomes available.*

7.6. Suspensions imposed on repeat offenders

Suspensions enacted for the provision of manifestly Illegal Content	Suspensions enacted for the provision of manifestly unfounded Notices	Suspensions enacted for the provision of manifestly unfounded complaints
0	0	0